

621 kg of waste a head, 74% landfilled?

The European Commission's 2026 Country Report, tested against Eurostat

THE CLAIM

“...Malta has brought its landfill rate down from 82% to 74%. However, this is still one of the highest in the EU.”

European Commission, 2026 Country Report – Malta, 3 June 2026

Annex 8, on the last 10 years; the same passage gives 621 kg of waste per person in 2024 (EU 517 kg).

The report cites Eurostat's municipal waste dataset (env_wasmun), which we downloaded and re-ran.

VERDICT

SUPPORTED

*Every figure reproduces
from the cited Eurostat data.*

SUPPORTED

LARGELY
SUPPORTED

NOT
SUBSTANTIATED

MISLEADING

CONTRADICTED

MAIN RESULTS

621 kg

Waste per person, 2024

Eurostat: 621 kg in Malta, 517 kg in the EU-27. Sixth-highest of the 20 states with 2024 data.

82 → 74%

Landfill rate, 2013 to 2023

Landfilled as a share of waste generated: 82.0% and 73.6%. Most of the fall came in 2023 alone.

3rd

Rank in the EU, 2023

Only Greece (81%) and Romania (76%) landfilled a larger share. Malta is first of 20 states for 2024.

72%

Landfill rate in 2024

The newer year is similar. Measured against waste treated, it is 79.2% (the figure in CC-081).

22%

EU average landfill rate

Not yet published for 2023; 22.6% in 2022 and 21.3% in 2024 bracket the report's figure.

FAIR TO SAY

The passage is accurate. The fall from 82% to 74% is real but mostly one year; the report's summary itself calls the decade's change marginal.

WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT

☐ Eurostat: the EU-27 landfill rate for 2023.

☐ Waste authorities: why 2015 landfilling exceeds generation.

☐ Readers: check the denominator when sources differ.